Brainstorming a semester-long course progression

PROMPT

Act as an instructional designer specialising in language teaching in blended environments (synchronous and asynchronous). You are well versed in theories of intrinsic motivation (Deci & Ryan, self-determination theory), the principles of second language acquisition (SLA), the neuroscience of learning, and active and game-based teaching approaches that have a concrete impact in the professional world. Your goal: to create a complete, coherent and pragmatic course architecture for a semester-long course.

I would like to design a course on the theme of [THEME]. Give me 7 options for immersive scenarios that ensure intrinsic motivation (justify your proposals) before generating the rest. Ask me questions before submitting scenarios if you are missing any information.

INSTITUTIONAL CONTEXT AND TARGET AUDIENCE

Institutional setting: [EXAMPLE: French university, languages for students of other disciplines (LANSAD), semester 1 of a first-year history degree]

Students' level: [EXAMPLE: CEFR A2+]

Number of students: [EXAMPLE: 30]

Group heterogeneity: [EXAMPLE: Very mixed; some have already lived in immersion (C1), others have never spoken the language (A1)]

Motivational profile: [EXAMPLE: Mainly extrinsic motivation (attendance at LANSAD classes is compulsory). Little emotional connection with the language.]

Technological context: [EXAMPLE: All have access to a computer and the internet. Minimal Moodle skills (compulsory institutional platform)]

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

[EXAMPLE: Self-determination theory (Deci & Ryan). Priorities: student autonomy + progressive competence + minimal but genuine social connection. Task-based approach (Ellis, CEFR). Priority on spoken production. Active learning (role play, debate, problem solving). No purely lecture-based teaching. Game-based learning (using game mechanics to create a state of flow, as distinct from gamification)]

LEARNING OBJECTIVES (COMPETENCY-BASED APPROACH)

Write 3 to 5 clear, measurable learning objectives following Bloom/Anderson.

Recommended format: By the end of the semester, students will be able to… [ACTION VERB + CONTENT + CONTEXT]

Objective 1: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the course, students will be able to take part in a group conversation on a current-affairs topic, sustaining the interaction for at least 10

minutes, using expressions of concession and markers of disagreement.]

Objective 2: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the course, students will be able to write an argumentative text (short essay) in English, at B1 level, on a STEM-related topic.]

Objective 3: [EXAMPLE: By the end of the course, students will be able to understand and summarise a 5–10-minute podcast or video in English with at least 80% comprehension.]

FORMAT, CONSTRAINTS AND ASSESSMENT

Total teaching hours: [EXAMPLE: 18 contact hours + unlimited asynchronous work]

Number of weeks: [EXAMPLE: 12 weeks (January–May)]

Synchronous/asynchronous rhythm: [EXAMPLE: Bisynchronous, 1.5 hours by video call per week (Wednesday 2 pm) + 2–3 hours of asynchronous work per week. Pedagogical rationale: synchronous interaction for speaking (real-time feedback needed), asynchronous for writing (reflection + revision).]

Available resources: [EXAMPLE: Moodle, Zoom, Genially licence, free tools.]

Assessment format: [EXAMPLE: Continuous assessment based on a portfolio + synchronous role plays + asynchronous assignments]

Assessment frequency and milestones: [EXAMPLE: 4 formal assessment milestones (weeks 3, 6, 9, 12) + informal weekly feedback. No final exam. 40% synchronous assessment (speaking), 60% asynchronous (writing + video production).]

Assessment weighting: [EXAMPLE: Synchronous participation 20% + written portfolio 30% + individual oral project 25% + reflective self-assessment 25%]

ROLE OF AI IN THE COURSE

Student support: [EXAMPLE: An asynchronous AI tutor (e.g. a chatbot on Moodle) to answer factual questions. No personalised feedback on written work (given by the teacher).]

EXPECTED DELIVERABLES

Complete course architecture: overall scenario, weekly plan (objectives per week + synchronous activities + asynchronous activities)

Content modules: [NUMBER] detailed modules

Learning activities: at least [NUMBER] activities per week, including synchronous and asynchronous interaction

Teacher resources: facilitation guides, Zoom scripts, time management

Assessment tools: grids, rubrics, marking schemes

VALIDATION CRITERIA

Pedagogical coherence: [EXAMPLE: Every activity must serve the objectives. Activities must genuinely get students speaking/writing. No “filler”. Every interaction must count.]

Adaptability to mixed levels: [EXAMPLE: A2+ and B2 levels in the same class → offer difficulty variants for each activity.]

Assessment frequency in line with workload: [EXAMPLE: No assessment every week (otherwise students are paralysed by the workload).]

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